

YASH KATARIA

04/21/2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am a Computer Science student at the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST), minoring in Actuarial Mathematics, and I am writing to express my interest in software engineering roles that sit at the interface of finance and technology. I am specifically drawn to positions where engineering directly enables trading operations, supports financial product development, or powers the infrastructure that markets depend on. I thrive where precision and performance are non-negotiable, and I bring both the technical depth and the execution mindset to contribute meaningfully from day one.

My most formative professional experience was at BNP Paribas, where I worked as a Software Engineering Trainee within Global Markets' Automated Market Making desk. I built production-grade automation systems to reduce manual intervention and latency in live trading workflows, maintained backtesting environments, and contributed to risk controls for algorithmic strategies. Working in that environment taught me what it means to write code that cannot fail, and gave me a DevOps mindset centered on reliability, speed, and continuous improvement. Prior to that, an internship in data analytics sharpened my ability to turn raw, messy data into decisions that matter at the executive level, bridging the gap between engineering and business.

Beyond professional experience, my projects have been my most honest teacher. Building an assistive navigation system for the visually impaired forced me to solve real engineering problems under real constraints: power, cost, latency, and lives depending on accuracy. It taught me system design from the ground up, how to manage cross-functional partnerships, and how to fundraise and execute simultaneously. Building a full-stack enterprise inventory platform taught me that great software is not just functional but maintainable, scalable, and user-driven. Replacing a proprietary analytics platform with an open-source alternative taught me to challenge assumptions about cost and capability. Each project demanded that I own the entire problem, not just a slice of it.

I am most drawn to roles in software engineering, systems development, and applied ML, particularly in environments that reward both technical rigor and ownership. I am comfortable across the full stack and across languages, but more importantly, I know how to learn fast, ship reliably, and think beyond the ticket.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background can contribute to your team.

Sincerely,
Yash Kataria